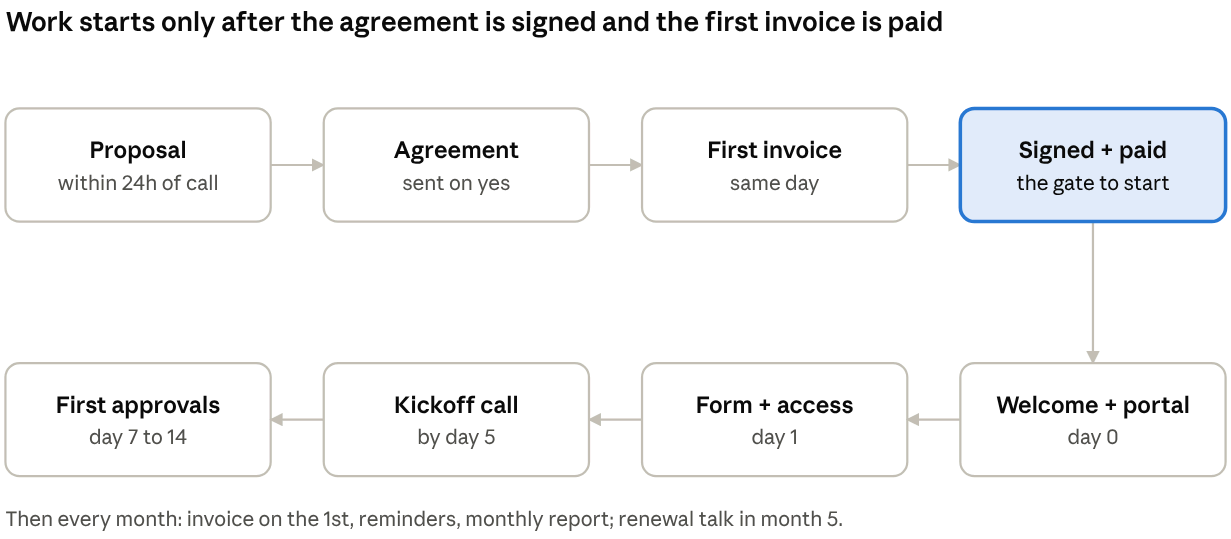
Vernex Client Onboarding Playbook

Oct 12, 2026 · @BOSS

A new client goes from proposal to first approved work in about two weeks, through one hard gate: a signed agreement and a paid first invoice. Everything after the gate runs from the admin portal.

The flow at a glance



Client onboarding flow · proposal to first approvals

The top row is selling; the bottom row is onboarding. Nothing on the bottom row starts until the gate is passed.

Step by step

Every new client gets the same 11 sends in the same order, from the proposal to the first monthly report. Work starts only after two things are true: the agreement is signed and the first invoice is paid. Skipping either is how agencies end up doing a month of work for free.

#	When	What you send	Channel	In the admin portal today
1	After the discovery call, within 24h	Proposal (scope, price, timeline, KPIs)	Email + PDF	Pipeline: move lead to **Proposal**
2	Proposal + 3 days, if no reply	Proposal follow-up	WhatsApp	Pipeline: lead next action
3	Client says yes	Agreement for signature	Email + PDF	Not yet: add **Documents** step
4	Same day as agreement	First invoice (month 1 retainer, or 50% website advance)	Email + payment link	Invoices tab
5	Agreement signed and invoice paid	Welcome message + portal invite	WhatsApp + email	Pipeline: **Convert to client**, then Team tab invite
6	Welcome + 1 day	Onboarding form and access checklist	Email	Not yet: add **Onboarding** checklist
7	Within 5 working days	Kickoff call (45 min) and written summary after it	Google Meet, then email	Projects tab: milestones from the call
8	Day 7 to 14	First deliverables for approval	Portal + WhatsApp nudge	Deliverables tab; Outbox reminders
9	3 days before each due date, then after	Payment reminders	WhatsApp + email	Outbox
10	First working day of each month	Monthly report and next month's plan	Email + portal	Performance page; AI Drafts
11	Month 5 of a 6-month term	Renewal conversation	Call, then email	Not yet: add renewal reminder

Who sends what. You (Boss) send 1, 3, 5, 7 and 11 personally; these are relationship moments. Your PM can send 2, 4, 6, 8, 9 and 10 from the portal.

Message templates

Copy, fill the brackets, send. Keep the tone of a growth partner: specific, calm, no hype words like "guaranteed" or "best agency".

1. Proposal email

```
Subject: [Business name] growth plan: next 90 days

Hi [Name],

Thank you for the time on [day]. As promised, the plan is attached.

What we heard:
- [Problem 1, in their words]
- [Problem 2]

What we'll do:
- Month 1: audit, strategy and setup ([key items])
- Month 2: launch and optimise ([key items])
- Month 3 onward: scale what works

What we'll measure: [KPI 1], [KPI 2], against your current baseline of
[baseline].

Investment: ₹[amount]/month + GST, for a [6]-month term. Ad spend is paid
directly to Meta/Google and is separate.

The proposal is valid until [date]. Happy to walk through it on a 15-minute
call this week.

Boss Anandaa
Founder, Vernex · vernex.in
```

2. Proposal follow-up (WhatsApp)

```
Hi [Name], Boss from Vernex. Did you get a chance to look at the plan?
Happy to adjust the scope if anything doesn't fit. Is a 15-minute call
on [day] at [time] okay?
```

3. Agreement email

```
Subject: Agreement: Vernex x [Business name]

Hi [Name],

Great to have you on board. Attached is our services agreement, covering
the scope, fees and terms we discussed.

Once it's signed and the first invoice is cleared, we start the same week.
The invoice is also attached, with a payment link.

Any questions on the agreement, just reply here.

Boss Anandaa
```

4. Welcome message (WhatsApp, after payment)

```
Welcome to Vernex, [Name]! 🙌 We're excited to grow [Business name] with you.

Here's what happens next:
1. You'll get an email to sign in to your Vernex portal. Everything lives
   there: approvals, files, reports and invoices.
2. Tomorrow we'll send a short onboarding form and the access we need.
3. Kickoff call: [day, date, time]. 45 minutes.

Your account lead is [Name], reachable on this number.
```

(One emoji in a WhatsApp welcome is fine; keep emails emoji-free.)

5. Welcome email with portal invite

```
Subject: Welcome to Vernex: your client portal is ready

Hi [Name],

Your Vernex portal is live: [portal link]
Sign in with this email address. No password needed; we send you a link.

In the portal you can:
- approve or request changes on every post, ad and page
- see your leads, reach and spend in one place
- download your files and invoices
- write to me directly through "Note to the founder"

Kickoff: [day, date, time], [Google Meet link].

Boss Anandaa
```

6. Onboarding form and access request

```
Subject: Before kickoff: 15 minutes of setup

Hi [Name],

To hit the ground running, please complete this before [date]:

1. Onboarding form (10 min): [form link]
2. Access (see the step-by-step guide attached):
   [the access list for their service, from the checklists below]
3. Upload your logo, brand colours and 10+ photos to Brand Assets in the
   portal.

We never ask for your passwords. All access is given through Meta Business,
Google and your hosting account's own sharing.

Thanks,
[PM name], Vernex
```

7. Kickoff summary

```
Subject: Kickoff summary and next steps

Hi [Name],

Thank you for today. What we agreed:
- Goals for 90 days: [goal 1], [goal 2]
- Baseline today: [numbers]
- First deliverables: [items], for your approval by [date]
- Your actions: [items], by [date]
- Our next check-in: [day, time]

The full plan is in your portal under Dashboard.

[PM name]
```

8. Invoice email

```
Subject: Invoice [INV-0001]: Vernex, [Month Year]

Hi [Name],

Please find invoice [INV-0001] for ₹[total] (₹[amount] + GST ₹[gst]),
due on [date].

Pay online: [Razorpay link]
Or bank transfer: [Account name], A/c [no.], IFSC [code], UPI [id]

Thank you,
Vernex Accounts
```

9. Payment reminders (WhatsApp)

- **3 days before:** `Hi [Name], a quick note that invoice [INV] for ₹[total] is due on [date]. Pay here: [link]. Thank you!`
- **On the due date:** `Hi [Name], invoice [INV] (₹[total]) is due today. Link: [link]. Let me know if you need anything from our side.`
- **3 days late:** `Hi [Name], invoice [INV] is 3 days overdue. Could you check with your accounts team? [link]`

- **7 days late:** `Hi [Name], invoice [INV] is now 7 days overdue. Please clear it by [date] so this month's campaigns run without a break.`
- **14 days late (Boss calls, then writes):** `As discussed on our call, we'll pause new work from [date] until invoice [INV] is cleared, as per clause [X] of our agreement.`

10. Monthly report

```
Subject: [Business name]: [Month] results and [next month] plan

Hi [Name],

The headline: [one sentence with the main number, e.g. "142 leads at ₹84
each, up 18% on September"].

What worked: [1-2 points]
What we're changing: [1-2 points]
Next month: [plan]

Full report in your portal: [link]

[PM name]
```

11. Renewal (after a call, in month 5)

```
Subject: The next 6 months for [Business name]

Hi [Name],

Thanks for the chat. Since we started: [baseline] -> [current numbers].

For the next term we recommend: [plan], at ₹[amount]/month + GST.
The new term would start on [date]. If you're happy, I'll send the renewal
agreement this week.

Boss Anandaa
```

Pitch for a cold lead stays with your daily lead briefs and outreach sequence (observation, problem, opportunity, offer, 15-minute call), so it isn't repeated here.

Agreement checklist

Keep your existing 4-page format (3 pages of terms plus the signature page, on the VerneX letterhead). Make sure every agreement covers the clauses below; the ones marked **new** are not in the AGK Fitness agreement as described in the project notes. This is a drafting checklist, not legal advice: have a lawyer review the master template once, then reuse it.

Both service types:

- [ ] Parties, GSTINs, addresses, start date, signatories
- [ ] Scope: deliverables per month or per project, listed specifically
- [ ] Out of scope, and how extra work is quoted (change request) **new**
- [ ] Fees, GST on top, payment due dates, late-payment terms and the right to pause work when an invoice is 14+ days overdue **new**
- [ ] Ad spend paid by the client directly to Meta or Google; 50% ad-budget advance before campaigns launch
- [ ] Third-party costs (domain, hosting, plugins, stock assets, booking engines) paid by the client
- [ ] Revision limits per deliverable, and that extra rounds are paid **new**
- [ ] Approval rule: feedback within 3 working days, or the item counts as approved; approvals given in the portal are binding **new**
- [ ] Client responsibilities: access, brand assets, timely feedback, a single decision-maker
- [ ] KPIs with baseline, target and measurement period; results are indicative, not guaranteed
- [ ] Ownership: the client owns paid-for final work; Vernex keeps working files and may show the work in its portfolio unless the client opts out **new**
- [ ] Confidentiality, and handling of the client's customer data under India's DPDP Act **new**
- [ ] Term, renewal and termination (for cause or non-payment during the fixed term)
- [ ] Account handover on exit: Vernex removes its own access and returns all assets **new**
- [ ] Governing law: India, courts at Chennai

Website projects only:

- [ ] Payment in milestones: 50% advance, 30% on design approval, 20% before launch
- [ ] Number of design rounds included, and the page list
- [ ] Content: who writes copy and supplies photos, and by when; delays on the client side move the launch date

- [ ] Source files and credentials handed over only after final payment
- [ ] Warranty: 30 days of free bug fixes after launch; changes after that are paid
- [ ] Optional maintenance plan as a separate monthly fee

Invoices and payments

Bill retainers in advance, on the 1st of each month, due within 7 days; bill websites in milestones. Never start a month's work on an unpaid invoice. Confirm the tax points below with your CA once; they depend on Vernex's GST registration.

Fields every invoice needs (GST-registered): Vernex legal name, address and GSTIN; invoice number in one series (INV-0001, INV-0002…); invoice date; client name, address and GSTIN; place of supply (state); description of the service and the month; SAC code; taxable value; GST rate and amount; total in figures and words; bank and UPI details; signature.

Tax quick reference (check with your CA):

- Digital marketing and web design are charged GST at 18%.
- Client in Tamil Nadu: CGST 9% + SGST 9%. Client in another state: IGST 18%.
- Client outside India: usually an export of services, zero-rated under a Letter of Undertaking (LUT), billed in their currency.
- If Vernex is not yet GST-registered (services turnover under ₹20 lakh a year), do not add GST; issue a plain invoice.
- Business clients may deduct TDS before paying. Ask at onboarding so the shortfall isn't a surprise.

Payment schedule:

Service	When you invoice	Due
Monthly retainer	1st of each month, for that month	7 days
Ad-budget advance	Before each campaign launch	Before launch
Website: advance	On signing	Before work starts
Website: design approval	When the client approves the design	7 days

Service	When you invoice	Due
Website: launch	Before the site goes live	Before launch
Extra revisions or change requests	When the client accepts the quote	7 days

The reminder ladder (3 days before, on the due date, then 3, 7 and 14 days late) is in the templates above. Mark each one sent in the portal's Outbox so you have a record.

Social media client checklist

A social media and ads client is ready to go live when access, brand assets and the first content batch are all in place, usually by day 10. Ask for access through Meta Business partner sharing, never the client's passwords.

Access (week 1):

- [ ] Instagram switched to a Professional (Business) account and linked to the Facebook Page
- [ ] Client adds Vernex's Business Portfolio as a **partner** in Meta Business Settings (Page, Instagram, ad account, pixel), using your Business ID
- [ ] Ad account: client's own, with their card on it, so ad spend never passes through Vernex
- [ ] Meta Pixel or Conversions API on their website; lead form or WhatsApp click-to-chat as the ad destination
- [ ] Google Business Profile manager access (for local businesses)
- [ ] Optional: YouTube channel and LinkedIn Page admin
- [ ] Client connects Instagram and Facebook in the portal so insights sync

Brand and content inputs:

- [ ] Logo (SVG or PNG), brand colours, fonts
- [ ] 20+ real photos and videos: space, team, customers (with permission)
- [ ] Offers, prices and USPs; what never to say
- [ ] Top 3 competitors and 3 accounts they admire
- [ ] Approver name and turnaround promise (3 working days)
- [ ] Shoot day booked if Vernex is creating video

Baseline, recorded on day 1 (screenshots in the Vault): followers, reach and engagement for the last 30 days, current leads per month and cost per lead, Google rating and review count.

Month-1 deliverables:

- [ ] Account audit with the top 5 fixes
- [ ] Bio, highlights and link-in-bio cleaned up
- [ ] Content pillars and a 30-day calendar for approval
- [ ] Ad campaign structure, audiences and first creatives for approval
- [ ] Lead handling: who answers enquiries, and how fast
- [ ] KPI targets agreed in writing against the baseline

Website client checklist

A website project runs in five gated stages, and each gate needs a client approval in the portal before the next starts. Most website delays come from content arriving late, so collect it in week 1, not week 4.

Stage	Typical length	What the client gives or approves	Gate
1. Discovery	Week 1	Questionnaire, goals, 3 sites they like, competitors	Signed-off brief
2. Sitemap and content	Week 1–2	Page list, copy (or approval of Vernex's copy), photos	Content approved
3. Design	Week 2–3	Home page design, then inner pages; included rounds only	Design approved, 30% invoice
4. Build on staging	Week 3–5	Review on a staging link, bug list in the portal	Staging approved, 20% invoice
5. Launch and handover	Week 5–6	Domain DNS change, final check	Live, then 30-day warranty

Access and accounts (in the client's name):

- [ ] Domain registrar access (GoDaddy, Hostinger, etc.) or a DNS user
- [ ] Hosting or platform account owned by the client

- [ ] Business email set up for enquiry forms
- [ ] Google Analytics 4 and Search Console: client owns, Vernex added as user
- [ ] Third-party tools in their name: booking engine, payment gateway, WhatsApp number

Discovery questionnaire (send as a form):

1. What should a visitor do on the site: call, WhatsApp, book, buy or enquire?
2. Who is the ideal customer, and what do they search for?
3. Services and prices to show, and which matters most?
4. Three websites you like, and why?
5. Must-have features: booking, payments, blog, multilingual (Tamil, Hindi), gallery?
6. Who writes the copy, and who approves it?
7. Launch deadline, and anything tied to it (an event or an offer)?

Launch checklist: mobile check on 2 real phones, page speed checked, forms tested end to end, SSL on, 301 redirects from old pages, GA4 and pixel firing, Google Business Profile link updated, backup taken, credentials and a short how-to video handed over.

After launch: offer a maintenance plan (updates, backups, small edits) as a monthly fee, and suggest the next step: ads or SEO to bring traffic to the new site.

What to add to the admin portal

The portal already covers half of this flow: Pipeline with **Convert to client**, the Team, Projects, Deliverables, Requests and Invoices tabs, the Outbox for reminders, and AI Drafts. Four additions close the gap, so a new client is onboarded from one screen instead of from WhatsApp and memory.

Add	Where	What it does
Onboarding tab	Admin → client page	Checklist from this playbook, picked by service type (social, website, both), with a progress bar and an owner per item
Templates library	Admin sidebar	The 11 messages above with merge fields filled from the client record; Copy, Send on WhatsApp, Open in email

Add	Where	What it does
Documents	Admin → client page, and client Vault	Proposal and agreement PDFs with status: draft, sent, signed
Client onboarding form	Client side, first login	Discovery questionnaire and access checklist the client fills in the portal

Claude Code prompt (Sonnet 5.5, high effort):

```
Read CLAUDE.md and docs/ONBOARDING_PLAYBOOK.md. Add client onboarding to the
portal on the existing mock data layer, using the UI kit, query hooks and
useCan() only.

1. Types and mock data: OnboardingItem (client_id, service: social | website
|
   common, stage, title, owner: vernex | client, status, due_date), Document
   (client_id, kind: proposal | agreement | other, file or Drive URL, status:
   draft | sent | signed, signed_at), MessageTemplate (key, title, channel:
   whatsapp | email, subject, body with {{merge_fields}}), and
   onboarding_answers on Client. Seed the checklists and the 11 templates
   from the playbook.
2. Admin client page: new "Onboarding" tab, first in the tab order. Pick the
   service type to generate the checklist; group items by stage; tick items;
   progress bar; overdue items in --bad. A banner shows the two gates:
   "Agreement signed" and "First invoice paid"; until both are true, show
   "Don't start work yet".
3. Admin client page: new "Documents" tab to add a proposal or agreement
   (upload or Drive link), mark it sent or signed.
4. Admin sidebar: "Templates" page listing the templates. Choosing a client
   fills the merge fields ({{client_name}}, {{contact_name}},
{{portal_link}},
   {{invoice_number}}, {{amount}}, {{due_date}}, {{kickoff_time}},
   {{lead_name}}). Buttons: Copy, Send on WhatsApp (wa.me link), Open in
email
   (mailto link). Staff can edit template text.
5. After "Convert to client" in the Pipeline, open the new client's
   Onboarding tab instead of the client list.
6. Client side: on first sign-in, if onboarding_answers is empty, show a
   short "Let's get set up" form (the discovery questions for their service
   type, plus the access checklist with a tick per item and a help link).
   Saving it marks the matching admin checklist items done.
7. Clients see their signed agreement in Vault > Documents; they never see
```

```
   drafts, templates or the admin checklist.
8. Tests: client cannot read templates or draft documents; ticking the
   client form updates the admin checklist. Run build, lint and tests.

Report what you added and the test results.
```

Before running it, export this doc as Markdown and save it in the repo as `docs/ONBOARDING_PLAYBOOK.md`, so the prompt can read the checklists and templates from it.